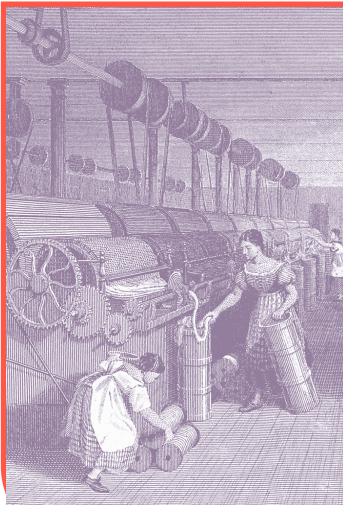


What next?

In the late 20th century, electronic technology brought more change. Computers and information technology revolutionized many of the service industries, such as banking, and with the advent of the internet new industries appeared such as social media sites and online trading. In some rich countries, service industries are replacing traditional manufacturing industries and agriculture, so much so that some people believe we are moving into a “postindustrial” age. Goods may be imported rather than manufactured, but even societies whose economies are based largely on service industries need housing, food, and manufactured goods. Even the most technologically advanced countries continue to maintain traditional industries in the agricultural, manufacturing, and construction sectors for their own use, if not for export.



THE INDUSTRIAL REVOLUTION

In Britain in the 18th century, the pace of scientific discovery accelerated, and with it came inventions of machines such as steam engines that revolutionized the way goods were produced. Mechanized mills and factories, and the introduction of rail transportation, spawned new industries, and a dramatic change in the economic structure of society.



Agriculture still accounts for nearly 40% of the world's workforce.

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